

DOLPHINLIKE REPTILES

Ichthyosaurs, such as *Stenopterygius*, resembled modern-day dolphins. Just like today's marine mammals, ichthyosaurs gave birth to live young. However, it is unknown whether they looked after their offspring like dolphins do.



The creature used its powerful tail to propel itself through the water.

Stenopterygius offspring

Birthing troubles

It is unclear how this *Stenopterygius* died. Some paleontologists have suggested that it died while giving birth, but others have argued that it probably died while pregnant and the unborn offspring was pushed out of its body as it decayed.

Fossils of up to eight unborn babies have been found in the wombs of some ichthyosaurs.